

# Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,  
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—  
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

EBENEZER 87.87.87.87

The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in E-flat major, 12/8 time. The key signature has three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with a vocal line and a piano accompaniment line. The piano part features a steady eighth-note accompaniment in the right hand and a more active bass line in the left hand. The lyrics are printed below the vocal lines, with three verses of text provided for each system. The first system includes three verses, the second system includes three verses, the third system includes three verses, and the fourth system includes three verses. The score concludes with a double bar line.

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,  
2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;  
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side;  
they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.  
though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust,  
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,  
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - 'rous to be just;  
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.  
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.